

This pencil is made of wood, which is not magnetic.

These steel paper clips are attracted to the magnet.

Steel scissor blades are magnetic.

Plastic scissor handles are not magnetic.

Magnetic poles

Two opposite poles **attract**, or pull on, each other. Two identical magnetic poles **repel** each other, or push each other away. This type of straight magnet is called a bar magnet.

A north and south pole attract each other.

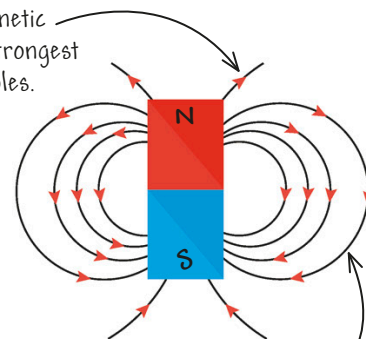


Two south poles push each other apart.

Magnetic field

A magnet acts on things that are nearby. The area in which a magnet attracts or repels magnetic materials is called the magnetic field.

The magnetic field is strongest at the poles.



Magnetic field lines run from north to south.

Many of these objects are made of steel—a metal that has iron in it.